AVIATESAIR

OM-A

Operations Manual Part A

General and basic: operating policy, flight planning, fuel, minima, SOPs, approach & landing, flight data monitoring.

REVISION	EFFECTIVE	DOCUMENTS	ISSUED BY
0	24 SEP 2026	9	AviatesAir Flight Operations

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For flight simulation use only. Not for real-world aviation.

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Introduction & Manual Control

How the AviatesAir document library is organised, how to read it (shall / should / may), revision control and which document takes precedence.

Welcome to AviatesAir. This Operations Manual sets out how we fly: the policies, procedures and standards every AviatesAir, CityHopper and Skycargo pilot follows. It is written the way a real airline writes its manuals, so that flying with us feels like flying for an airline, while staying practical for a virtual operation.

> CAUTION AviatesAir is a **virtual airline** for flight simulation. Nothing in this library is approved or certified data, and none of it may be used for real-world aviation.

The document library

MANUAL	CONTENTS
Company NOTAMs (CN)	Current operational notices. Read and **acknowledge** every active notice before your next flight.
OM-A: General / Basic	Operating policy, flight planning, fuel, weather and minima, SOPs, approach and landing policy, flight data monitoring, online operations, abnormal and emergency policy.
OM-B: Aircraft Operating Matters	One chapter per fleet: key data and limitations, company configuration policy, handling notes.
QRH: Quick Reference Handbook	Normal checklists for every type (identical to the EFB **Checklists** app) and immediate-action items.
Pilot Guides	The AviatesAir Tracker, ACARS and EFB, plus weather and performance know-how.

Order of precedence

When two documents disagree, apply the **first** in this list:

1. **ATC instructions** and the safety of the flight (in the simulator)
2. **Company NOTAMs**: they amend the manuals until the manuals are revised
3. **OM-B** for your aircraft type
4. **OM-A**
5. The aircraft add-on's own documentation (FCOM/QRH/FCTM supplied with it)
6. Pilot Guides

> NOTE Aircraft data in OM-B are typical figures for the type. Where your add-on's own limitations differ (engine option, weight variant, software standard), **the add-on's figures apply**.

Terminology

WORD	MEANING
shall / must	Mandatory. Deviations may lead to a PIREP being held for review.
should	Recommended practice. Deviate only with good reason, and brief it.
may	Optional; at the pilot's discretion.
PF / PM	Pilot Flying / Pilot Monitoring. Flying alone you do both, but think in both roles.
AAL / AGL	Above aerodrome level / above ground level.

Revisions

Every document shows its **revision number** and **effective date**. When a document is revised, its revision number increases. A revised Company NOTAM must be acknowledged again. Suggestions and corrections are welcome: raise them with AviatesAir staff on Discord.

Operational Policy & Flight Planning

The AviatesAir operation: subsidiaries and callsigns, bookings, routes, registrations, repositioning, the OFP and the life of a flight from booking to PIREP.

The operation

AviatesAir flies scheduled passenger and cargo services under three operating brands. Each has its own ICAO designator used for ATC callsigns and SimBrief dispatch:

OPERATING BRAND	ICAO DESIGNATOR	FLEET
AviatesAir Mainline	**VAV**	A320neo · A350 · A380 · 737-800 · 737-900ER · 737 MAX 8 · 747-8
AviatesAir CityHopper	**VAH**	A319 · 737-600 · ATR 72-600 · ATR 42-600
AviatesAir Skycargo	**VAC**	777F

Callsigns and flight numbers

- **Route flight numbers** always use the **AV** prefix (e.g. *AV150*). This is the number shown on the booking and in the logbook.
- The **ATC callsign** uses the operating brand's designator plus 1–4 characters: up to four digits, optionally ending in up to two letters (e.g. *VAV34NE*, *VAH64E*, *VAC023F*). The Tracker generates it when you book.
- File exactly the callsign shown on your booking in SimBrief and on your network flight plan. The radiotelephony callsign is spoken as designator plus suffix (for example "*VAV three four november echo*").

Bookings

- You hold **one booking at a time**. Complete or cancel it before booking another.
- A booking defines the **route, flight number, aircraft type and scheduled departure time**.
- Once a booking is **activated** (the flight has started), it is locked and can no longer be cancelled.
- **Charter** bookings are available for flying outside the published schedule.
- **Event flights** earn the event's hours multiplier when you confirm attendance at the event reminder before departure.

Punctuality

Plan to be off blocks at the scheduled time. A departure **more than 20 minutes after the scheduled departure time** is recorded and the PIREP is held for review. If you are running late, cancel and rebook rather than departing an hour late on an old booking.

Routes and aircraft types

Only fly a type from an airport that has **AviatesAir routes for that type**; the Routes page lists them. Registrations are pooled fleet-wide; see CN-001.

Repositioning

Your position is the destination of your last completed flight. If you need to be somewhere else to fly the route you want, the **Reposition** action on the Routes page may be used **once every 7 days**. Otherwise, fly there.

The life of a flight

1. **Book** the flight in the Tracker.
2. **Plan**: generate the SimBrief OFP with the booked flight number, callsign, type and your registration, then import it in the Tracker **ACARS** page. The OFP flows automatically into the EFB (Pilot Brief, Departure Perf, Dashboard).
3. **Brief**: read the Company NOTAMs and the OFP, check weather and NOTAMs for departure, destination and alternates, and compute takeoff performance.
4. **Fly**: keep the **Tracker running and connected to the simulator for the whole flight**, from the gate to the gate. Flight phases, the route, fuel and the landing are recorded automatically.
5. **Arrive**: park, set the parking brake and shut down. The Tracker completes the flight and submits the **PIREP** automatically.
6. **Review**: read your landing report in the EFB **Landing** app. If the PIREP is held for review, add your comment (see OM-A 6).

> **NOTE** If the simulator or the Tracker crashes mid-flight, restart the Tracker: flight recovery resumes the recorded flight. A PIREP that fails to send is retried automatically at the next start.

Pilot responsibilities

You shall:

- fly the **booked** route and type, with a realistic OFP,
- follow ATC and published procedures when flying online,
- operate within the aircraft's limitations and the company restrictions in the Company NOTAMs,
- avoid using simulation "cheats" (slew, time acceleration, unrealistic fuel or weight edits, pausing mid-approach) on a recorded flight.

Fuel Policy

How AviatesAir plans fuel (taxi, trip, contingency, alternate, final reserve, additional, extra), in-flight fuel management and the MINIMUM FUEL / MAYDAY FUEL declarations.

AviatesAir follows an ICAO/EASA-style fuel scheme. SimBrief calculates it for you; this chapter explains what each figure is for, so you can judge whether the OFP makes sense.

Planned fuel

COMPONENT	AVIATESAIR POLICY
Taxi	Expected taxi-out burn, including APU use. Use the OFP figure; add more at congested hubs.
Trip	Takeoff to landing at destination, including the expected departure and arrival procedures.
Contingency	**5 % of trip fuel**, never less than **5 minutes** of holding at 1,500 ft above destination.
Alternate	Missed approach at destination, climb, cruise and approach to the **destination alternate**.
Final reserve	**30 minutes** holding at 1,500 ft above the alternate, for jets and turboprops alike.
Additional	Only when needed so that fuel never falls below final reserve (e.g. an isolated destination with no alternate).
Extra	Commander's discretion: weather, expected holding, ATC delays, online event congestion.

Minimum takeoff fuel = trip + contingency + alternate + final reserve + additional. **Block fuel** = minimum takeoff fuel + taxi + extra.

> **NOTE** Busy online events regularly add 10–20 minutes of holding or vectoring. Carry extra fuel accordingly and note it in your briefing.

Destination alternate

A destination alternate is required unless the flight is very short and the destination weather is well above minima. Choose one that has suitable runways and weather above the planning minima in OM-A 3. Our long-haul fleet (A350, A380, 777F, 747-8) should always carry one.

Tankering

Carrying fuel for the next sector is permitted when the OFP shows a saving and the landing weight stays within limits. Never tanker if it would push the landing weight above MLW or erode landing performance on a limiting runway.

In-flight fuel management

- Check **fuel on board against the OFP** at every waypoint or at least every 30 minutes. The EFB Dashboard shows the predicted arrival fuel against the planned figure.
- Investigate any trend of more than **5 %** or an **imbalance**: fuel leak, wrong cruise level, headwinds.

- Plan to land with **at least final reserve plus alternate fuel** at destination. If that is no longer possible, re-plan early: a lower level, a closer alternate, or a diversion.

Fuel declarations

CALL	WHEN
"MINIMUM FUEL"	You are committed to landing at a specific aerodrome, and any further delay may result in landing with **less than final reserve**. This is not an emergency. It tells ATC that further delay is not acceptable.
"MAYDAY MAYDAY MAYDAY FUEL"	The fuel you are calculated to have on landing at the nearest suitable aerodrome is **less than final reserve**. This is an emergency.

> CAUTION Final reserve is there to be protected, not used. A landing below final reserve is a reportable occurrence. Mention it in your PIREP comment.

Weather, Minima & Runway Condition

Planning minima for destinations and alternates, takeoff and landing minima, crosswind and tailwind policy by runway condition code (RWYCC), low-visibility operations and the Global Reporting Format.

Planning minima

An aerodrome may be planned as a **destination** or **destination alternate** only if the forecast (TAF, including TEMPO/PROB groups) for **one hour before to one hour after** the expected arrival time is at or above:

APPROACH AVAILABLE	DESTINATION	DESTINATION ALTERNATE
Precision approach (ILS CAT I / GLS / LPV)	Published minima	DA/H **+ 200 ft** and RVR/VIS **+ 800 m**
Non-precision (RNP LNAV / LNAV/VNAV, VOR, NDB)	Published minima	MDA/H **+ 400 ft** and RVR/VIS **+ 1,500 m**
Circling	Published circling minima	Circling minima **+ 400 ft / + 1,500 m**

A **takeoff alternate** within one hour's flying time (one engine inoperative, still air; two hours for the A350, 777F, 747-8 and A380) is required when departure weather is below the landing minima for the departure runway.

Takeoff and approach minima

- **Takeoff:** minimum RVR/visibility **400 m** with centreline lighting; **550 m** without. Lower values need low-visibility procedures (LVP) in force at the airport, where the simulator scenery and network ATC support them.
- **Approach:** fly to the minima published on the chart. Set the DA/MDA on the minimums selector during the approach briefing.
- **Approach ban:** do not continue an approach below **1,000 ft AAL** if the reported RVR/visibility is below the required minimum.

Crosswind and tailwind

Company crosswind guidance is based on the **runway condition code (RWYCC)** and matches the EFB Arrival Perf warnings. Never exceed the aircraft's demonstrated crosswind (your add-on's FCOM).

RWYCC	RUNWAY DESCRIPTION	MAX CROSSWIND (INCL. GUSTS)
6	Dry	**33 kt**
5	Wet (≤ 3 mm water), frost	**33 kt**
4	Compacted snow (≤ −15 °C OAT)	**25 kt**
3	Wet "slippery", dry snow or wet snow over compacted snow	**25 kt**
2	Standing water or slush (> 3 mm)	**15 kt**
1	Ice	**15 kt**

RWYCC	RUNWAY DESCRIPTION	MAX CROSSWIND (INCL. GUSTS)
0	Wet ice, water on compacted snow	**Operations not permitted**

- **Tailwind:** maximum **10 kt** for takeoff and landing unless the add-on's AFM allows more; never on a contaminated runway (RWYCC ≤ 4).
- Gust factor: add the full gust to the crosswind when comparing with the limit.

Runway condition and the Global Reporting Format (GRF)

Runway state is reported as a **runway condition report (RCR)**: a RWYCC for each third of the runway (e.g. *RWYCC 5/5/3*), plus contaminant type, depth and coverage. Use the **lowest** code of the thirds you will use, and select it in EFB Arrival/Departure Perf. Pilots report braking action as **GOOD** (5), **GOOD TO MEDIUM** (4), **MEDIUM** (3), **MEDIUM TO POOR** (2), **POOR** (1) or **LESS THAN POOR** (0).

> CAUTION On contaminated runways, performance calculations must assume **no reverse thrust credit** for dispatch, and you should plan the **longest available runway**.

Low-visibility operations

CAT II/III approaches are permitted only when:

- the aircraft and add-on support autoland to the required category,
- the airport publishes the approach and ATC declares LVP in force (online), and
- you brief the automatic callouts, minima (DH or alert height) and go-around.

Thunderstorms, icing and windshear

- **Thunderstorms:** avoid active cells by at least **20 NM** laterally in cruise (10 NM below FL200). Never take off or land with a storm over the airport or on the approach path.
- **Icing:** use engine and wing anti-ice as the aircraft procedures require. Airframe de-icing is required before takeoff with frost, snow or ice on critical surfaces.
- **Windshear:** reported moderate or severe windshear, or a predictive windshear alert: **delay** the takeoff or approach. See the QRH immediate actions if you encounter it.

Standard Operating Procedures

Flight-deck philosophy, PF/PM duties, flows and checklists, briefings, sterile flight deck, automation, altimeter setting, speed limits, taxi, APU use and noise abatement.

Philosophy

Fly the aircraft first: **aviate, navigate, communicate**. Every AviatesAir flight is flown to the same standard whether it is recorded, online or offline, so that good habits become automatic.

PF and PM duties

PILOT FLYING (PF)	PILOT MONITORING (PM)
Flight path and speed control	Radio communication
Aircraft configuration (calls for flap, gear)	Selects flap/gear on the PF's call and confirms
Navigation and automation mode selection	Monitors the flight path, calls deviations
Calls for checklists	Reads checklists

Flying single-pilot in the simulator, you do both. Keep the discipline anyway: make the calls, then verify them.

Flows and checklists

1. **Flows** configure the aircraft from memory, panel by panel.
2. **Checklists** then *verify* that the critical items were done. They are **read–verify**, not read–do.
3. Read the challenge, check the item, state the response. Stop at the **line** on Airbus checklists until the clearance is received.
4. Use the checklist for **your type**. The EFB **Checklists** app selects it from your booking automatically; the QRH has the same checklists in print.

Briefings

Departure briefing (before start): runway and intersection, takeoff performance (flap, thrust, V-speeds), the SID and initial altitude, transition altitude, engine-failure and emergency turn procedure, return plan, taxi route and hot spots, weather and anything unusual.

Approach briefing (before top of descent): the ATIS, STAR and transition, approach type and minima, landing flap and autobrake, landing distance and runway exit, missed approach and go-around altitude, diversion fuel and the alternate, taxi to stand.

> **NOTE** A briefing is a plan you can fly, not a recital. Brief the threats first ("*what could catch us out today?*"), then the plan.

Sterile flight deck

Below **10,000 ft**, and whenever on the ground with engines running, only operationally relevant activity takes place: no cabin PAs except safety-related ones, no chat, no photos, no reading the news. On a stream or voice channel, go quiet.

Automation

- Use the **appropriate level** of automation. Hand-flying practice is encouraged in good weather and light traffic; **engage the autopilot** in busy airspace, in IMC, in RVSM airspace and when workload is high.
- **Know what the FMA says.** Read every mode change aloud.
- If the automation does something unexpected, **take it one level down** (managed → selected → manual) before troubleshooting.

Altimeter setting

- **Departure:** set QNH before start. Set **STD (1013 / 29.92)** when passing the **transition altitude** in the climb.
- **Arrival:** set destination QNH when cleared to an altitude, or at the **transition level** in the descent.
- **Cross-check** both altimeters and the standby after every change. The EFB shows the planned transition altitude in Pilot Brief and Departure Perf.

Speed limits

CONDITION	MAXIMUM
Below **FL100** (unless ATC or a published procedure says otherwise)	**250 kt IAS**
Holding (ICAO, up to FL140)	**230 kt**
Flap and gear extension	Placard speeds, see OM-B
Taxi, straight line	**30 kt** GS (20 kt on wet or contaminated surfaces)
Taxi, turns more than 30° and ramp areas	**10 kt** GS

Ground operations

- **Pushback:** only with the parking brake released on the tug's instruction, beacon **ON**, doors closed.
- **Engine start:** after pushback clearance. Heavies start the second engine(s) after the tug is disconnected, if the ground crew permit.
- **Taxi:** follow the cleared route with the airport chart displayed. Stop and ask when in doubt. Use taxi lights at night and runway turnoff lights as needed.
- **Single-engine taxi** is permitted for fuel saving where the add-on supports it: after landing when the engine has cooled (typically three minutes), and never on contaminated surfaces.
- **APU:** use ground power where available. Start the APU no earlier than necessary before pushback, and shut it down after arrival once ground power is connected.

Noise abatement departure

Unless the airport or ATC specifies otherwise, fly **NADP 2**:

1. Takeoff thrust and V2 + 10–20 kt to **1,000 ft AAL**.
2. At 1,000 ft AAL: lower the nose, reduce to climb thrust, accelerate and retract flaps on schedule.
3. Climb at clean speed to 3,000 ft AAL, then accelerate to 250 kt.

Where the SID requires **NADP 1**, reduce to climb thrust at 800–1,500 ft but keep takeoff flap and V2 + 10–20 kt until **3,000 ft AAL**.

Approach & Landing Policy

Stabilised-approach criteria and gates, the no-fault go-around policy, landing technique, touchdown zone, autobrake and reverse use, landing flap policy and runway vacating.

Stabilised approach criteria

An approach is **stabilised** when **all** of the following are true:

1. The aircraft is on the correct **lateral and vertical flight path**, needing only small changes of heading and pitch.
2. It is in the **landing configuration**: gear down, landing flap set (at or above the company minimum for the type; see CN-003).
3. The speed is between **VREF (VLS on Airbus) and VAPP + 10 kt**, and not decreasing below the target.
4. The **rate of descent is no greater than 1,000 fpm**. If a higher rate is expected (a steep approach or a high groundspeed), it must be briefed.
5. **Thrust** is stabilised, spooled up and appropriate for the configuration.
6. **Bank angle** is no more than 10° below 500 ft; wings level by 50 ft except for crosswind correction.
7. All **briefings and checklists** are complete. The LANDING checklist is done by 1,000 ft.

Gates

GATE	HEIGHT	REQUIREMENT
IMC gate	**1,000 ft AAL**	Stabilised, in IMC and on every instrument approach.
VMC gate	**500 ft AAL**	Stabilised, in visual conditions on a visual approach. Configuration must be complete by 1,000 ft.

> **WARNING** If the approach is **not stabilised at the gate**, or becomes unstable below it, a **GO-AROUND is mandatory**. There is no "just this once".

The EFB Landing report shows your 1,000 ft and 500 ft gate states from the recorded approach, and the Tracker holds a PIREP for review when gear, flap or speed were not stabilised by 1,000 ft (see OM-A 6).

Go-around policy

AviatesAir has a **no-fault go-around policy**. Nobody is ever criticised for going around. A go-around is a normal manoeuvre, and a well-flown one is a sign of good airmanship. Go around when:

- the approach is not stabilised at the gate,
- the required visual reference is not established at the minima,
- there is a runway incursion, an obstacle, or an ATC instruction to go around,
- windshear, a long flare or a bounce means you can't touch down safely in the touchdown zone,
- you have any doubt.

After a go-around, fly the published missed approach unless ATC instructs otherwise. Re-brief before a second attempt. After **two** unsuccessful approaches, divert unless the reason has clearly gone away.

Landing technique

- **Aim** for the touchdown aiming point (the large markings about 1,000 ft / 300–400 m past the threshold). Cross the threshold at about **50 ft**.
- **Touchdown zone:** touch down within the **touchdown zone**, the first **3,000 ft (900 m)** past the threshold (or the first third of a shorter runway), ideally close to the aiming point. A touchdown beyond it is a **long landing**, and one less than 200 ft past the threshold is a **short landing**. If the touchdown point is running long, go around rather than chase it.
- **Flare** at the type's normal height (roughly 20–30 ft on narrow-bodies, higher on heavies), reduce thrust smoothly and **don't float**. A firm, on-speed touchdown in the zone beats a long "butter".
- **Crosswind:** use the type's recommended technique. Crab to the flare, then de-crab with rudder, cross-controlling with aileron as needed so the aircraft touches down aligned with the centreline.
- Lower the nose wheel promptly and smoothly. **Stay on the centreline.**

Deceleration

- **Autobrake:** select to match the runway: LOW/2 for long dry runways, MED/3 for normal or wet runways, MAX only for short or contaminated runways (BTV on the A350/A380 where available).
- **Reverse thrust:** idle reverse at least on every landing where available. Full reverse on short, wet or contaminated runways, cancelled by about 60 kt (per type).
- Plan the **runway exit** in the approach briefing and aim to vacate without delay, especially at busy online events.

Landing flap policy

Use the **standard landing flap** for your type unless there is a reason not to. The **company minimum** in CN-003 applies to the 737 and A320 family.

Flight Data Monitoring & Landing Assessment

What the Tracker records, how landings are scored and graded, the FDM event limits, which exceedances hold a PIREP for review, and the just culture behind it.

Real airlines run a **Flight Data Monitoring (FDM)** programme: every flight's data is recorded and analysed to find trends and improve safety. AviatesAir does the same with the Tracker. The aim is **learning, not punishment**.

What is recorded

For every flight: the flight phases, route and altitude profile, block and air times, fuel, and every landing. For every landing: the full approach from about 2½ minutes before touchdown through the rollout (altitude, speeds, vertical speed, pitch, bank, flap and gear), plus the touchdown values. You can review any of your last 25 landings in the EFB **Landing** app.

Landing score

Each landing is scored out of **100** on six factors:

FACTOR	POINTS	FULL MARKS
Vertical speed at touchdown	**30**	≤ 250 fpm (25 pts to 400, 15 to 600, 8 to 800, 3 to 1,000)
Pitch attitude at touchdown	**20**	1.5–3.5° nose-up (15 pts 0.5–5°, 8 pts 0–7°)
Bank angle at touchdown	**15**	< 1° (12 < 2°, 8 < 3°, 4 < 5°)
Speed at touchdown	**15**	100–145 kt IAS (10 pts 80–160 kt, 5 pts 60–180 kt)
Crosswind component	**10**	< 2 kt, scaling down to 1 pt at 15 kt or more
Approach stability	**10**	Stabilised approach (2 pts if not)

> **NOTE** The speed band suits the narrow-body fleet. Heavies (A380, 747-8, 777F) naturally touch down faster and lose a few points there. Compare your heavy landings with each other, not with the A320.

SCORE	GRADE
90–100	**EXCELLENT**
75–89	**GOOD**
60–74	**FAIR**
40–59	**HARD**
0–39	**VERY HARD**

The **butter rating** (PURE BUTTER · BUTTER · SMOOTH · SOLID · FIRM · HARD) is the fun part: it's based on vertical speed alone and has no bearing on review.

> **NOTE** A *SOLID* 200–300 fpm touchdown in the touchdown zone is exactly what airlines want, especially on a wet or short runway. Don't float the aircraft down the runway chasing a butter landing.

FDM events

The landing report lists exceedances as **WARNING** (red), **CAUTION** (amber) or **NOTE**. These are AviatesAir's event limits, not aircraft limitations:

EVENT	CAUTION	WARNING
Vertical speed at touchdown	≥ 600 fpm	≥ 800 fpm
Pitch at touchdown (tail-strike margin)	≥ 7.5° (or nose-low < 0°)	≥ 9.0°
Bank at touchdown	≥ 3°	≥ 5°
Bounce	1 bounce	2 or more
Touchdown past the threshold	> 2,500 ft	> 3,000 ft (long landing)
Touchdown short	n/a	< 200 ft past the threshold
Centreline deviation	≥ 30 ft	≥ 60 ft
Rate of descent below 1,000 ft AAL	≥ 1,000 fpm	≥ 1,500 fpm
Bank below 500 ft	≥ 10°	≥ 15°
Unstabilised at a gate	1,000 ft gate	500 ft gate
Tailwind at touchdown	n/a	≥ 10 kt
Crosswind component	≥ 25 kt	n/a
Crab angle at touchdown	≥ 5°	n/a
No flare detected	note	n/a

Held for review

A PIREP is **held for review** by staff, not rejected, when any of the following occurred:

- **Hard landing:** touchdown vertical speed above **800 fpm**,
- a **bounced** landing,
- **gear, landing flap or approach speed not stabilised by 1,000 ft AGL** (landing flap at or above the company minimum counts; see CN-003),
- touchdown more than **60 ft** from the centreline, or outside **200–3,000 ft** past the threshold (where the runway is in the Tracker's database),
- a climb or descent rate above **8,000 fpm** at any point,

- cruise airspeed outside a safe band (jets 250–530 kt IAS, turboprops 150–300 kt),
- off blocks more than **20 minutes** after the scheduled departure.

When a flight is held, the Tracker asks for your comment. **Explain what happened** (for example "gusting 25 kt, bounced and went around", or "ATC kept us high, descent rate 1,400 fpm to regain the path"). Honest context is all that's needed.

Just culture

- Honest mistakes and honest reports are **never** punished. We learn from them.
- **Recklessness** is not acceptable: deliberate, repeated disregard of SOPs, limits or ATC, or manipulating the simulator to fake a flight.
- Trends matter more than single events. Staff may offer tips or a check flight if the same event keeps recurring.

Online Network Operations

Flying AviatesAir on VATSIM and IVAO: flight plans, callsigns and remarks, radio discipline, UNICOM, CPDLC/Hoppies, events and simulating non-normals online.

Flying online is encouraged, and it's what makes our events come alive. On a network you share the sky with real people, so **the network's rules come first**: the VATSIM Code of Conduct or the IVAO rules, and the controller's instructions.

Before you connect

- File a **flight plan** that matches your OFP: route, cruise level, aircraft type with equipment and wake category, and your alternate. SimBrief can prefile it for you.
- **Callsign:** your booking callsign (VAV / VAH / VAC + suffix; see OM-A 1).
- **Remarks:** include `/V/` (voice) and `RMK/AVIATESAIR VIRTUAL`, plus anything ATC should know (e.g. `RMK/NEW TO THE AREA`). If ATC asks how to say your callsign, spell out the designator and suffix.
- Connect **at the gate**, never on a runway or taxiway. Set your transponder to standby or as the network requires.

On the frequency

- **Listen before you talk.** Plan the call, then make it in one go.
- Use standard **ICAO phraseology** and read back clearances, runway, altitude, heading, speed and squawk.
- If you don't understand, say so: "*Say again*". Nobody minds.
- Check in with **callsign, level and anything asked for** (the ATIS letter, SID or STAR).

When there's no ATC

Monitor and self-announce on **UNICOM 122.800** (VATSIM) or the network's published unicom. Give position and intentions at key points: pushback, taxi, lining up, departing, established on final, vacating.

Datalink

- Where the controller provides it, request **departure clearance (PDC/DCL)** and use **CPDLC** logon via Hoppie's ACARS.
- AviatesAir's own ACARS messages (loadsheet, timings) come through Hoppies when it is enabled in the Tracker; they're company messages, not ATC clearances.

Events

- For events, **book early**, arrive at the gate in good time and **carry extra fuel** for holding.
- Keep speeds as assigned. On a busy frequency, keep transmissions short and vacate promptly after landing.
- Confirm attendance at the event reminder so the event's hours multiplier is applied (see OM-A 1).

Non-normals online

- You may simulate a non-normal only if you can **fly it realistically without disrupting other traffic**. On a busy event, don't.
- Tell ATC early and plainly what you need ("*…request return to the field, engine failure, VAV12 heavy*"). Don't surprise them with a squawk change.
- **Never squawk 7500** (unlawful interference) on any network.
- If the simulator misbehaves (a crash, or a freeze on final), leave the frequency and **disconnect** rather than stay connected as a hazard.

Abnormal & Emergency Policy

Declaring an emergency, squawk codes, diversion decisions, overweight landings, rejected takeoffs, tail strikes and hard landings, and reporting occurrences.

Handling a non-normal

1. **Fly the aircraft.** Maintain control and a safe flight path, then use the automation.
2. **Identify** the problem: ECAM/EICAS messages, warnings and indications.
3. Carry out the **immediate actions** (memory items) where they apply. See the QRH.
4. Work through the **ECAM or QRH checklist** for the type in your add-on.
5. **Decide:** continue, return or divert. Use a structured model such as **T-DODAR** (Time, Diagnose, Options, Decide, Assign, Review).
6. **Communicate** with ATC, and brief the cabin in the simulator.

Declaring an emergency

CALL	USE FOR
MAYDAY MAYDAY MAYDAY	Grave and imminent danger requiring immediate assistance: engine fire, loss of all engines, depressurisation, smoke, MAYDAY FUEL.
PAN PAN, PAN PAN, PAN PAN	Urgency, where the safety of the aircraft or a person is at risk: engine failure after it's secured, medical emergency, a significant system failure.

Squawk codes

CODE	MEANING
7700	Emergency, unless ATC has already assigned another code.
7600	Radio failure. Follow the published loss-of-communications procedure.
7500	Unlawful interference. **Never used** at AviatesAir (see OM-A 7).

Diversion

Divert when continuing to destination is no longer safe or sensible:

- weather below minima with no improvement expected within your fuel,
- a non-normal requiring a **landing at the nearest suitable airport** (fire not confirmed out, smoke, a single remaining power source, the ECAM/QRH says so),
- a medical emergency,
- fuel below what is needed for destination plus reserves.

A diverted flight is a normal outcome. Land, park, and let the Tracker complete the flight. Explain the diversion in the PIREP comment.

Overweight landing

Landing above MLW is permitted **only** when a delay to reduce weight would compromise safety (fire, smoke, medical). Fly a stabilised approach at the correct VAPP with the maximum landing flap, and land smoothly: aim for **less than 360 fpm** at touchdown. An overweight landing always requires an inspection, so report it.

Rejected takeoff

- **Below 80 kt** (100 kt on the Airbus fleet): reject for any significant failure or warning.
- **80 kt / 100 kt to V1:** reject only for engine failure or fire, a predictive windshear warning, unsafe configuration warnings or if the aircraft is unsafe or unable to fly.
- **After V1:** continue the takeoff. The problem is dealt with in the air.

The PF calls "**STOP**" and performs the RTO actions (see QRH).

Tail strike and hard landing

- **Suspected tail strike:** don't pressurise the aircraft further than needed. Return to the departure airport for inspection (see CN-002).
- **Hard landing** above 800 fpm, or a heavy bounce: the aircraft needs an inspection before the next flight. The PIREP is held for review automatically; add your comment.

Reporting occurrences

Report in your PIREP comment (or to staff on Discord) any of: a tail strike, a hard or overweight landing, a landing below final reserve fuel, a runway excursion, a TCAS RA, a GPWS warning, a windshear encounter, a level bust, or any event you think others could learn from. Reports are handled under our **just culture** policy (OM-A 6).